Week 10, Lecture 1: Likelihood Ratio Tests, AIC, and Regularization

Instructor notes. Part 1: prep reading. Part 2: podium cheat sheet

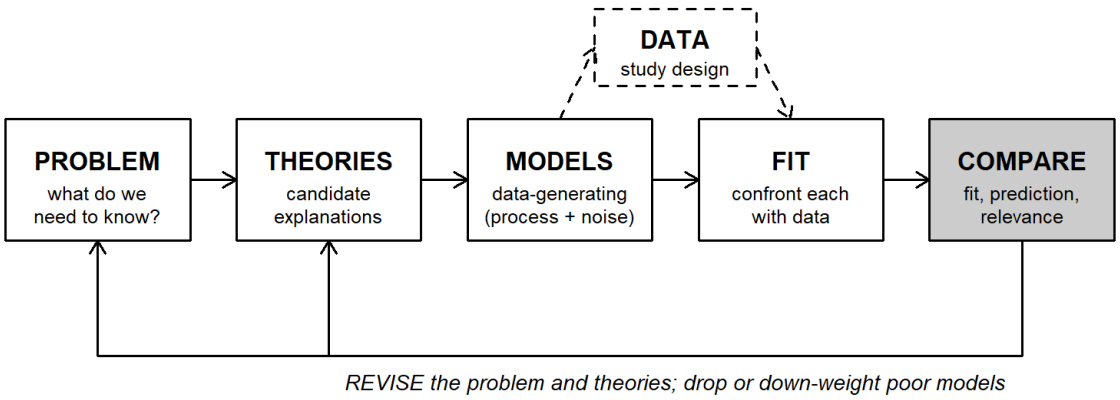
Overview (instructor only)

Beat	Mode	Time
1. Big picture	BOARD	~4 min
2. WOD: *Connect the Dots*	handout	~8 min
3. Likelihood ratio test	BOARD → R	~8 min
4. AIC	BOARD → R	~10 min
5. Ridge and lasso	BOARD → R	~12 min
6. Wrap and discussion	BOARD	~5 min

- R = Monday section of `CODE_Week10_ModelComparison.R`. No Stan debrief (lab).
- **Behind?** Skip the Poisson pause and AICc/BIC; past minute ~38, do section 5's board part only and open Wednesday with the glmnet demo.

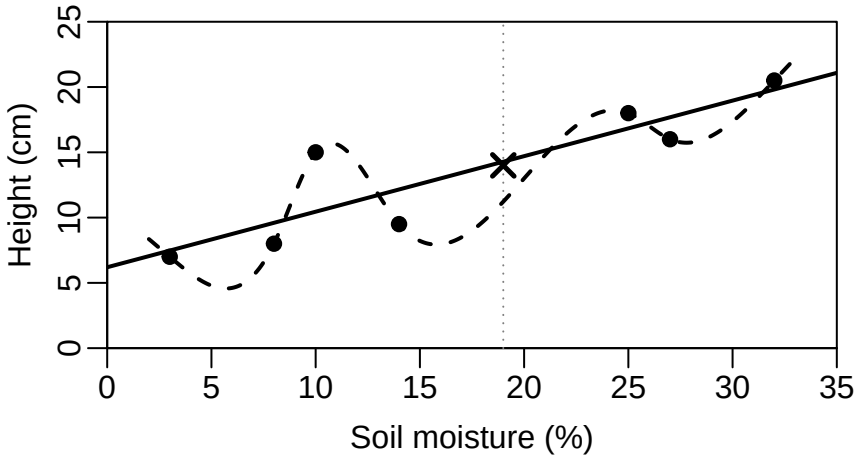
Part 1: Lecture content

1. Big picture (~4 min) [BOARD]



- COMPARE = fit / prediction and rivals / relevance; today is the middle one
- Tools: penalize in-sample fit (LRT, AIC), held-out data (CV), or fit skeptically (ridge, lasso)
- Survivors are corroborated, not proven

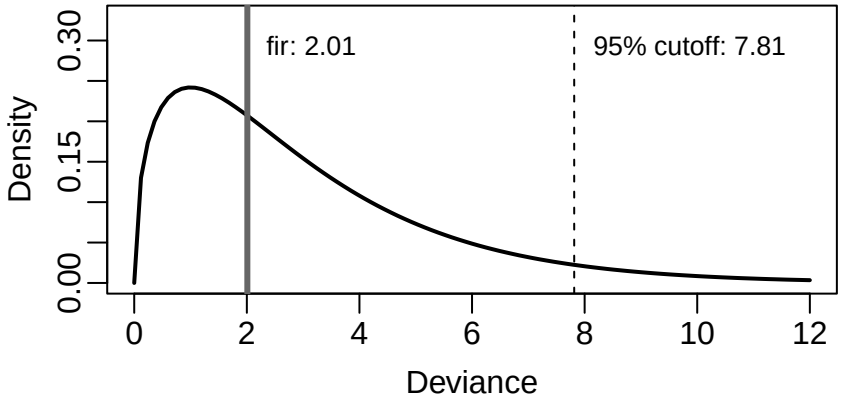
2. WOD reveal (~8 min) [handout]



- Residual SS: line 35.2, curve 0
- New plot **14 cm**; line 14.3, curve 11.2
- Land: in-sample fit always improves with flexibility

3. Likelihood ratio test (~8 min) [BOARD → R]

- Fir (Bolker 6.6): cones $\sim$ NegBin$(a\,\mathrm{DBH}^b, k)$; full (wave/non-wave a, b, k; 6 params) vs. no-wave (3)
- $D = 2(\mathrm{NLL}_{red} - \mathrm{NLL}_{full}) \sim \chi^2_r$; nested models only
- Week 7's 1.92 = this test with $r = 1$



- **Result:** $D = 2.01$, $p = 0.57$; keep no-wave

- **Pause:** Poisson nested in NB? Yes ($k \to \infty$; legacy LECTURE8 is wrong), but on the boundary, so naive p is ~2x too big. $D = 4{,}052$ here
- **Sticking point:** not rejecting $\neq$ no difference

4. AIC (~10 min) [BOARD → R]

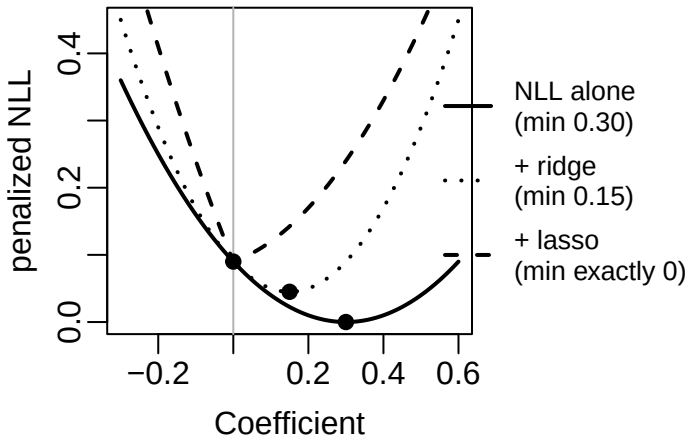
- AIC $= -2 \log \mathcal{L}(\hat{\theta}) + 2k$; nested or not, same response data
- $2k$ = average in-sample optimism (`NOTES_Reference_AICPenalty.Rmd`; don't derive)
- $w_i = e^{-\Delta_i/2} / \sum_j e^{-\Delta_j/2}$; BIC: $k \log n$

	k	NLL	AIC	dAIC	weight	dBIC
no_wave	3	1136.02	2278.03	0.00	0.52	0.00
const_ak	4	1135.76	2279.52	1.48	0.25	4.97
const_b	5	1135.13	2280.27	2.24	0.17	9.21
full	6	1135.01	2282.02	3.99	0.07	14.46
poisson	2	3161.83	6327.66	4049.63	0.00	4046.14

- **Pause:** weight 0.52 = P(true model)? No; relative support within the set (Bolker p. 284)
- **Sticking point:** `const_ak` adds 1 param, NLL down only 0.26, yet $\Delta = 1.48$. A useless parameter costs ≤ 2 (Arnold 2010)

5. Ridge and lasso (~12 min) [BOARD → R]

- Creepers: 50 stations, 10 covariates, simulated (say so); truth = big trees, snags, road distance
- $2^{10} = 1024$ subsets; instead penalize coefficient *size*: NLL$+\lambda \sum \beta_j^2$ (ridge), NLL$+\lambda \sum |\beta_j|$ (lasso)
- Standardize first; λ by 10-fold CV (`lambda.1se`)
- Lasso's corner at 0 gives exact zeros:



- **Full MLE:** all 10 nonzero; north 0.22, elev 0.11 (truth 0)
- **All-subsets AIC:** big_trees, snags, north, road_dist; 8 within 2; best weight 0.08
- **Lasso (CV):** big_trees, snags, road_dist; big trees 0.37 (truth 0.5), road 0.07 (0.3)
- **40 simulated datasets**, exact true set: AIC 12, lasso 13
- **Pause:** road 0.07 vs. 0.3, broken? No: bias traded for lower variance; for effect sizes refit or go Bayesian (Wed.)
- **Sticking point:** neither method is a truth detector

6. Wrap and discussion (~5 min) [BOARD]

- Count penalty / held-out data / size penalty. Tomorrow: pond survey. Wed.: WAIC, LOO, shrinkage priors

Q1. AIC kept northness (8 models within 2, best weight 0.08); the lasso dropped it. Which covariates would you report as "important," and how would you word it?

Q2. In a real survey, the lasso sets grazing to exactly 0. A manager concludes expanding grazing won't affect creepers. Agree?

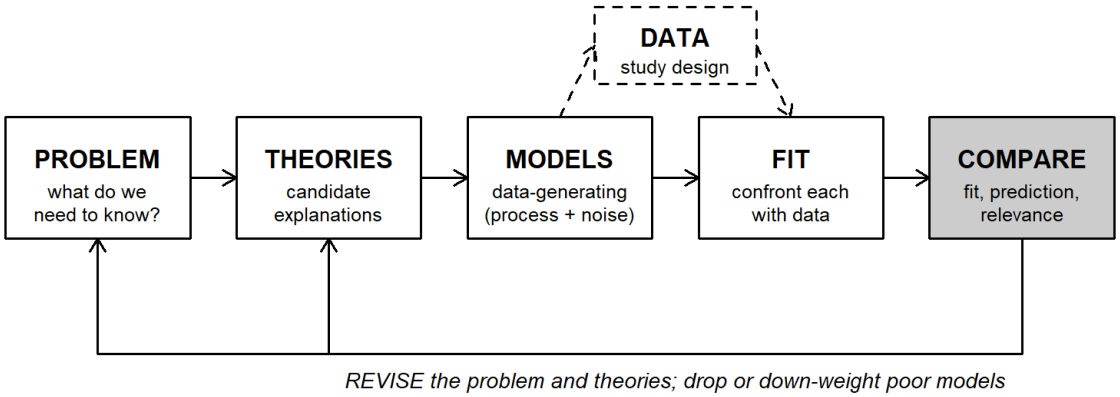
- Q1 lands on: report selection uncertainty; agreed covariates (big trees, snags) are safest
- Q2 lands on: zero = not needed for prediction here, not "no effect"; grazing may act via shrub cover; causal question = COMPARE (3), relevance

PART 2: PODIUM CHEAT SHEET

Terse on purpose. Detail: Part 1. R = Monday section of CODE_Week10_ModelComparison.R.

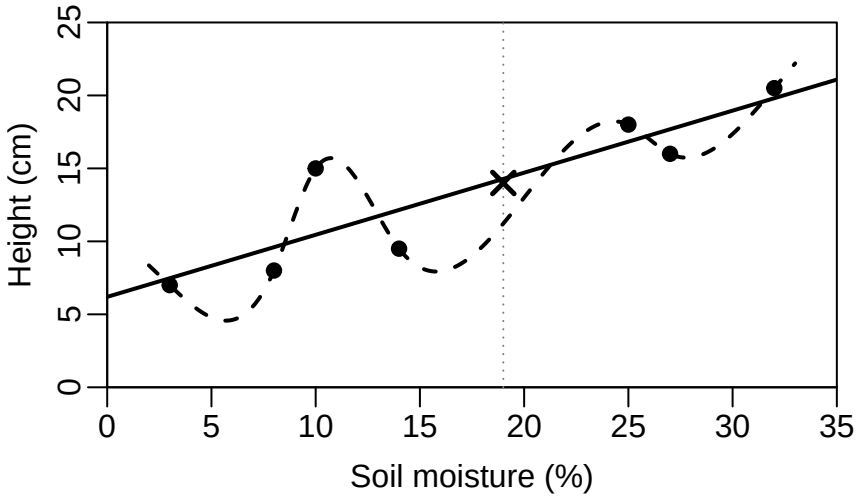
Big picture → WOD → lecture. No Stan debrief (lab). Behind? Skip Poisson pause, AICc/BIC; glmnet demo → Wed.

1. Big picture (~4 min) [BOARD]



- Point at **COMPARE**: fit / prediction + rivals / relevance
- Weeks 6-9 = FIT; today = rivals
- Penalize in-sample fit (LRT, AIC); new data (CV); fit skeptically (ridge, lasso)
- Corroborated, not proven
- Hand out WOD

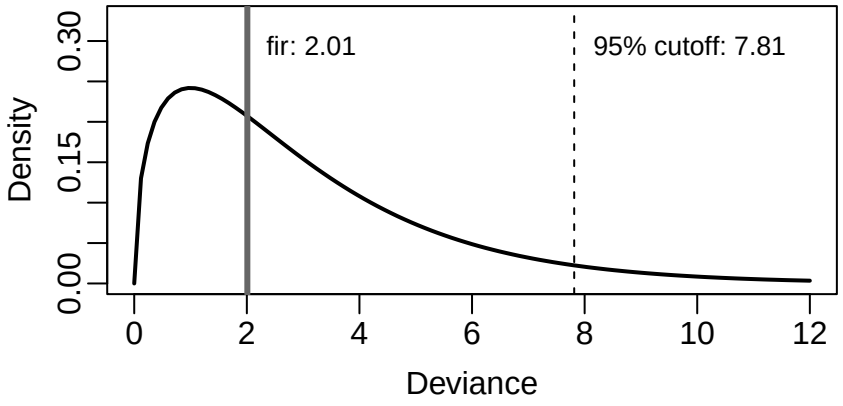
2. WOD reveal (~8 min)



- Residual SS: line 35.2, curve 0
- New plot: **14 cm**; line 14.3, curve 11.2
- Curves disagree in the gap; lines don't
- In-sample fit always improves with flexibility

3. LRT (~8 min) [BOARD → R]

- Fir: NegBin($a\,\mathrm{DBH}^b$, k); wave vs. non-wave
- Full 6 params vs. no-wave 3; **nested**
- $D = 2(\mathrm{NLL}_{red} - \mathrm{NLL}_{full}) \sim \chi^2_r$
- Week 7's $1.92 = 3.84/2$, $r = 1$



- **R:** $D = 2.01$, cutoff 7.81, $p = 0.57$; keep no-wave
- **Pause (skippable):** Poisson nested in NB? Yes ($k \to \infty$), but on the boundary: naive p ~2x too big. $D = 4{,}052$
- Not rejecting $\neq$ no difference

4. AIC (~10 min) [BOARD → R]

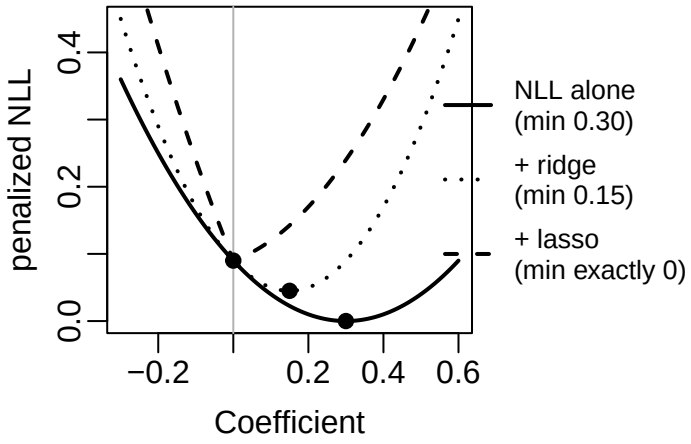
- AIC $= -2 \log \mathcal{L}(\hat{\theta}) + 2k$; any models, same response data
- $2k$ = average optimism (the WOD in one number)
- $w_i = e^{-\Delta_i/2} / \sum_j e^{-\Delta_j/2}$
- AICc: small n; BIC: $k \log n$

	k	NLL	AIC	dAIC	weight	dBIC
no_wave	3	1136.02	2278.03	0.00	0.52	0.00
const_ak	4	1135.76	2279.52	1.48	0.25	4.97
const_b	5	1135.13	2280.27	2.24	0.17	9.21
full	6	1135.01	2282.02	3.99	0.07	14.46
poisson	2	3161.83	6327.66	4049.63	0.00	4046.14

- **Pause:** weight 0.52 = P(true)? No (Bolker p. 284)
- `const_ak`: +1 param, NLL down 0.26, Δ 1.48. Useless param costs ≤ 2

5. Ridge and lasso (~12 min) [BOARD → R]

- Creepers: 50 stations, 10 covariates; simulated; truth = big trees, snags, road
- $2^{10} = 1024$ subsets
- NLL + $\lambda \sum \beta_j^2$ (ridge); NLL + $\lambda \sum |\beta_j|$ (lasso)
- AIC: how many; these: how big. Standardize first



- **R:** MLE: north 0.22, elev 0.11
- Best subset: big_trees, snags, north, road_dist; 8 within 2; weight 0.08
- Paths; CV → `lambda.1se`: big_trees, snags, road_dist
- **Pause:** road 0.07 vs. 0.3. Broken? No: bias for lower variance
- 40 datasets: AIC right 12, lasso 13

6. Wrap and discussion (~5 min)

- Count penalty / held-out data / size penalty
- Tomorrow: pond survey. Wed: WAIC, LOO, shrinkage priors

Q1. AIC kept northness (8 within 2, best weight 0.08); lasso dropped it. What do you report as "important"?

- Report uncertainty; agreed covariates are safest

Q2. Real survey: lasso zeroes grazing. "Expanding grazing won't affect creepers." Agree?

- Zero = not needed for prediction here; not "no effect"
- Grazing via shrub; small effect, 50 stations; causal question = COMPARE (3)